



— BRAND GUIDELINES

The MdS Websites brand, in one place.

Everything you need to design consistently for the company —
strategy, logo, colour, type, voice and applications.

MdS Websites
YOUR LOCAL DIGITAL PARTNER

Version 1.0
June 2026

What's inside

01	Brand Strategy	Positioning, audience, mission and values
02	Brand Voice & Tone	How we sound, in words and writing
03	Logo	The wordmark, monogram, clear space and misuse
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06	Visual Identity	Icons, motifs, buttons and imagery
07	Applications	Social, email, invoice, proposal, reports, merch
08	Contact	Details and asset library

Business sense, not just design taste.

MdS Websites is a founder-led digital growth studio in Cambridge, combining 12+ years of design and development with 30+ years of real-world business and management experience.

POSITIONING

A research-first digital growth partner for ambitious small and growing businesses. We don't just build websites — we help owners attract more customers, win more enquiries and grow revenue, with strategy behind every decision.

MISSION

To help ambitious businesses grow through branding, websites and digital marketing that are built around how their customers actually search, decide and buy.

WHO WE SERVE

Growing organisations across Cambridge and the East of England:

Professional services

Hospitality & tourism

Education

Trades & construction

Transport

Local SMEs

OUR VALUES

Research before pixels

Strategy isn't an add-on. Every project starts with market, competitor and customer research.

Results over awards

Measured in enquiries, bookings and revenue — not how it photographs.

Plain English, always

No jargon. You'll understand every recommendation and every invoice.

Honest scoping

If a refresh will do, we won't sell a rebuild. Trust beats short-term revenue.

Craft matters

Typography, speed and accessibility are where premium feel comes from.

Growth is a partnership

Launch is the start, not the finish. We optimise together.

Senior, warm and straight-talking.

We sound like an experienced partner who respects your time: confident without hype, plain without being plain-looking.

PRINCIPLES

Lead with the outcome

Talk about enquiries, bookings and revenue before features.

Be specific

Concrete numbers and real examples over vague claims.

Plain English

If a client wouldn't say it, we don't write it. British spelling throughout.

Honest & calm

No pressure, no buzzwords. Quiet confidence earns trust.

DO & DON'T

DO

✓ "Win more enquiries"

✓ "We research first"

✓ "Here's what it costs"

✓ "A faster site"

✓ Short, clear sentences

DON'T

✗ "Synergistic solutions"

✗ "World-class, cutting-edge"

✗ "POA / hidden pricing"

✗ "Leverage paradigms"

✗ Long jargon stacks

TAGLINE

Your Local Digital Partner

Use as a supporting strapline beneath the logo. Title case. Never reworded.

The wordmark & monogram.

MdS Websites
YOUR LOCAL DIGITAL PARTNER

M

M

MdS Websites
YOUR LOCAL DIGITAL PARTNER

Primary wordmark — Fraunces with the gold "S". Dark version for light/cream backgrounds; light version for navy.

Monogram — the "M" with gold underline. Use the navy rounded-square app icon for avatars, favicons and merch; the open monogram where space is tight.

CLEAR SPACE & SIZING

Keep clear space around the logo equal to the height of the "M". Minimum widths: wordmark 32 mm / 150 px; monogram icon 16 px.

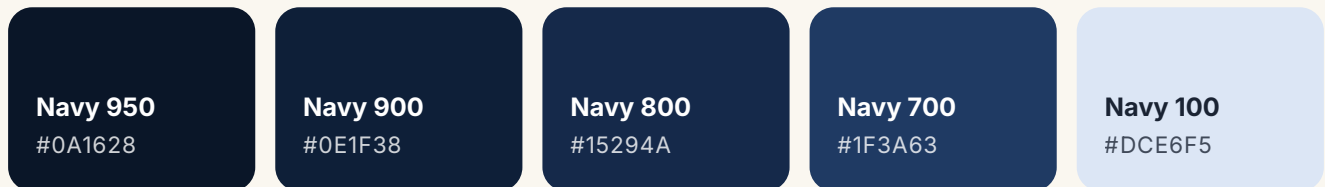
MISUSE — NEVER

- ✗ Recolour or add gradients
- ✗ Stretch, squash or rotate
- ✗ Swap the fonts
- ✗ Add shadows or outlines
- ✗ Place on low-contrast/busy photos

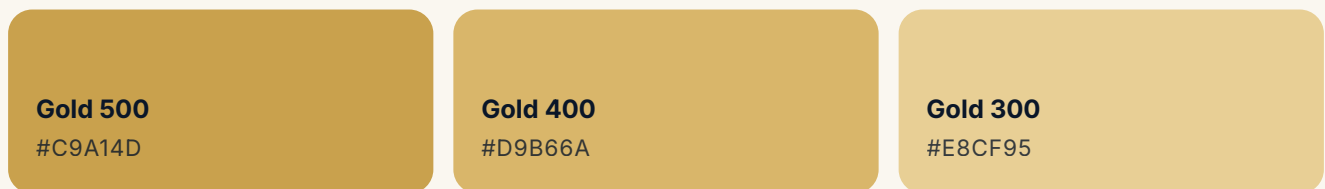
Deep navy, warm gold.

Navy leads and grounds everything; gold is the accent that signals quality — used sparingly (roughly one-tenth of any layout).

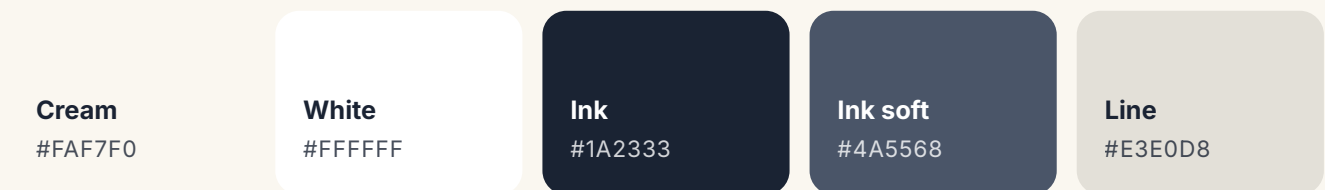
NAVY — PRIMARY



GOLD — ACCENT



NEUTRALS



USAGE

Navy 950 for primary surfaces, headers and text on light. Cream is the default page background; white for cards. Gold 500 for accents, links, key figures and CTAs — never for body text.

ACCESSIBILITY

White on Navy 950 and Navy 950 on Cream both exceed WCAG AA. Gold 500 on navy passes for large text/UI; avoid gold text on white or cream at small sizes.

Fraunces & Inter.

DISPLAY — FRAUNCES

Aa

Grow with confidence

Serif. Weights 400 / 600 / 700. Headings, pull-quotes, key numbers. Default 600, tight tracking (-0.015em).

BODY — INTER

Aa

Clear, legible body copy for everything else.

Sans. Weights 400 / 500 / 600 / 700. Body, UI, labels, captions. Body 10.5–11pt, line-height 1.6.

TYPE SCALE

STYLE	FONT	WEIGHT	SIZE / USE
Heading 1	Fraunces	600	40–68px · page titles
Heading 2	Fraunces	600	30–46px · sections
Heading 3	Fraunces	600	20–25px · sub-sections
EYEBROW LABEL	Inter	700	UPPERCASE · 0.16em tracking · gold, with dash
Body text	Inter	400	17px · line-height 1.65
Caption / small	Inter	500–600	13–14px · meta, captions

The supporting system.

THE GOLD DASH MOTIF

— WHY CHOOSE US

Every section opens with a gold dash + uppercase eyebrow. A consistent, recognisable signature.

ICON TILES



Simple line/solid icons in navy rounded-square tiles (radius 11-14px), gold glyphs.

SHAPES & ELEVATION



Rounded corners 14px (cards) / 22px (large). Soft navy-tinted shadows, never harsh black.

BUTTONS



Pill buttons. Gold = primary action; navy = secondary; outline on light backgrounds.

IMAGERY

Real, warm, professional photography. Natural light, genuine people and places. Avoid generic stock and heavy filters. A navy/gold duotone is available for accents.

Social templates.

Editable Canva templates accompany this kit (LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, YouTube). Sizes and layout rules below.

LINKEDIN

Profile/Page logo	400 × 400
Cover banner	1584 × 396
Post (square)	1200 × 1200
Link post	1200 × 627

INSTAGRAM

Profile	320 × 320
Portrait post	1080 × 1350
Square post	1080 × 1080
Story / Reel	1080 × 1920

FACEBOOK

Profile	170 × 170
Page cover	820 × 312
Shared post	1200 × 630

YOUTUBE

Channel art	2560 × 1440
Safe area	1546 × 423
Thumbnail	1280 × 720

LAYOUT RULES

Navy or cream background. Monogram or wordmark in a corner. One Fraunces headline, gold dash eyebrow, generous space. Profile pictures always use the navy app-icon monogram. Keep text inside platform safe areas.

Email, invoice, proposal & more.

Specs so every business document looks unmistakably MdS.
(Built on request as your next step.)

EMAIL FOOTER

Martin Spooner

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Wordmark or name in Fraunces, details in Inter, gold left-rule. Social icons optional.

INVOICE

Navy header band with monogram + "Invoice"; gold accent rule; Inter body; totals in navy with the balance-due figure highlighted gold. Footer: company details + payment terms.

PROPOSAL COVER

Full-bleed navy, monogram top-left, project title in Fraunces, gold dash eyebrow ("Proposal"), client name. Inside pages on cream with white cards.

SEO REPORT

Navy cover with "SEO Report" + period. Data in Inter tabular figures; charts in navy/gold; key metrics as big Fraunces numbers with gold accents.

MERCHANDISE

Monogram app-icon on navy or cream; gold-foil suggested for print. Totes, tees, mugs, stickers — keep clear space and never recolour.

Let's keep it consistent.

Use this kit whenever you design for MdS Websites.
Questions or new templates — get in touch.

CONTACT

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SOCIAL

LinkedIn — [TBC]
Instagram — [TBC]
Facebook — [TBC]
YouTube — [TBC]

ASSET LIBRARY (SUPPLIED)

Wordmark (dark/light) · Monogram (app icon, light/dark) · Favicon · Social share image ·
Static fonts. SVG + PNG.

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Brand Guidelines v1.0
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